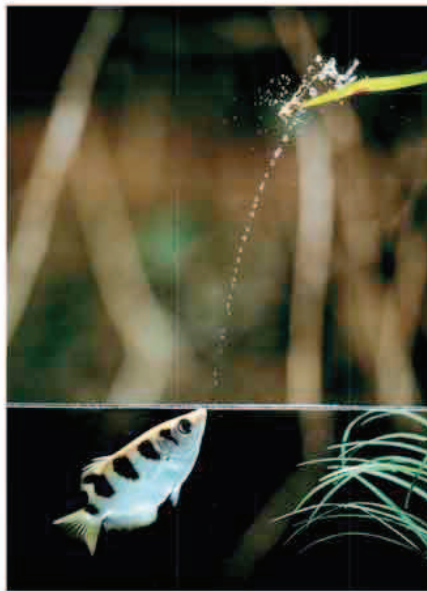


SHARPSHOOTER

Some fish are specialized for living among mangroves. They include the archerfish of Southeast Asia. As it swims through the flooded forest, it looks for insects on overhanging plants above the surface. When it spots its prey, the fish squirts a jet of water at it, knocking it into the water where it can snap it up.

► ARCHERFISH

The fish's tongue fits against a groove in the roof of its mouth to form a tube. It forces water out of this tube by squeezing its cheeks together—it can hit a target more than 6.5 ft (2 m) away.



► FIDDLER CRAB

Male fiddler crabs have a small feeding claw, and a bigger, brightly colored claw that they use for signaling to other male crabs in territorial displays.



► MUDSKIPPER

Each mudskipper lives in a burrow in the wet mud. It defends its burrow against invasion from other mudskippers, especially during the breeding season when the burrow acts as a nursery.



POWERFUL PREDATORS

The fiddler crabs and mudskippers foraging on the mud at low tide are hunted by a variety of land-based animals, including raccoons, monkeys, and the venomous mangrove snake. Some of these fall prey to powerful predators such as saltwater crocodiles and even tigers. The Sundarbans mangrove swamp at the mouth of the Ganges River in India and Bangladesh is one of the last habitats of the Bengal tiger, and is now a protected wildlife reserve.

